

牛津习语词典

习语	中文解释	常用 / 口语	例句
from A to 'B	从一处到另一处	常★★★★ □★★★★	I don't care what kind of car it is as long as it gets me from A to B. 我倒不在乎是什么样的车，只要能把我从一处载到另一处就可以了。
from A to 'Z	从头至尾；详尽彻底地	常★★★★ □★★★★	We need an expert who knows the subject from A to Z. 我们需要一位精通这门学科的专家。
be taken a'back (by sb/sth)	大吃一惊；被吓一跳	常★★★★ □★★★★	She completely was taken aback by his anger. 他勃然大怒，把她吓了一跳。
be about to do sth	正要做事；即将做事	常★★★★★ □★★★★	I was about to phone him when he walked into the room. 我正要给他打电话，他进屋了。
how/what about...?	(询问情况或提出建议) 怎么样	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	How about Ruth? Have you heard from her? 露丝怎么样了？你有她的消息吗？
how/what about 'that (, then)? (informal)	(表示惊讶或赞叹) 是吗；太妙了	常★★★ □★★★★★	She got the scholarship on her first try — how about that, then! 她第一次申请就拿到奖学金了，你说妙不妙！（自拟）
not be about to do sth	不愿做事；无意做事	常★★★★ □★★★★	I've never done any cooking and I'm not about to start now. 我从没做过饭，现在也不打算做。
that's about 'all/it	就这些；没别要说了	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Milk, bread, a bag of rice — that's about it for the shopping list. 牛奶、面包、一袋米，购物清单就这些了。（自拟）
above 'all ('else)	尤其是；最重要的是	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Don't spend too much, don't forget to write, but above all, have a good time! 别花太多钱，别忘了写信，最重要的是，要玩得开心！
a,bove and be'yond sth (formal)	超越（职责等）；不止于	常★★★★ □★★	They showed commitment to the job above and beyond what was expected of them. 他们的敬业精神超乎人们对他们的期望。
be/get a'bove yourself (disapproving)	自命不凡；狂妄自大	常★★★ □★★★★	She's getting a bit above herself. She's only been working for me for two weeks and already she's telling me what to do! 她也有点太自负了，才为我工作了两个星期，就开始对我指手画脚！
keep a'breast of sth	了解...的最新情况；跟上...的发展	常★★★★ □★★	It is almost impossible to keep abreast of all the latest developments in computing. 要跟上计算机领域所有最新的发展几乎是不可能的。
,absence makes the heart grow 'fonder (saying)	离别情更浓；小别胜新婚	常★★★★ □★★★★	They text all day now he's abroad — absence makes the heart grow fonder. 他出国后两人整天发消息，真是小别胜新婚。（自拟）
leave of 'absence (formal)	准假；休假	常★★★★ □★★	He asked for three months' leave of absence to look after his sick father. 他申请了三个月假期去照顾生病的父亲。（自拟）
by 'accident	偶然；意外地	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We met by accident at the airport. 我
(whether) by ,accident or de'sign	不论是偶然还是有意	常★★★ □★★	Whether by accident or design, his email went to the whole company. 不管是无心还是有意，他那封邮件发给了全公司。（自拟）
acci,dentially on 'purpose (informal, ironic)	故作意外地；假装无意地	常★★★ □★★★★	She accidentally on purpose left her number on his desk. 她故作无意地把电话号码留在了他桌上。（自拟）
accidents will 'happen (saying)	意外总是难免的	常★★★★ □★★★★	Don't cry over the broken vase, sweetheart — accidents will happen. 别为打碎的花瓶哭了，宝贝，意外总是难免的。（自拟）
of your own ac'cord	自愿地；主动地	常★★★★★ □★★★★	I didn' need to tell her to apologize; she did it of her own accord. 不需要我告诉她，她主动道歉了。
of little/no ac'count (formal)	无关紧要；无足轻重	常★★★ □★	His past achievements were of no account when it came to competing with the younger men. 要说跟较年轻的人竞争，他过去的成就就不值一提了。
on 'no account •not on 'any account	决不；无论如何都不	常★★★★ □★★	On no account should you open that door while the machine is running. 机器运转时你决不能打开那扇门。（自拟）
on your own ac'count	为自己；自行负责地	常★★★ □★★	She quit the agency and started trading on her own account last spring. 去年春天她离开中介，开始自己单干做买卖。（自拟）
put/turn sth to good ac'count (formal)	充分利用（金钱、才能等）	常★ □★	He put his years in the kitchen to good account when he wrote the book. 写这本书时，他把多年的厨房经验用了个够。（自拟）
take sth into ac'count •take account of sth	考虑到；把...考虑在内	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We must take rising prices into account when we plan next year's budget. 做明年预算时我们一定要把物价上涨考虑进去。（自拟）
there's no accounting for 'taste(s) (saying)	人各有所好；好恶无从解释	常★★★★ □★★★★	He put ketchup on his noodles — well, there's no accounting for taste. 他往面条上浇番茄酱，唉，人各有所好吧。（自拟）
by/from 'all accounts	据大家所说；据说	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Tve never seen any of her moves, but she's a brilliant director, by all accounts. 我从未看过她的电影，不过大家都说她是位才华横溢的导演。
play your 'ace	打出王牌；使出绝招	常★★★ □★★★★	I think it's time we played our ace, which is the fact that without us they wouldn't be able to run this place. 我认为该是打出我们王牌的时候了：没有我们他们管理不了这里。
within an ace of sth/of doing sth (BrE)	差一点儿；几乎	常★ □★★	We came within an ace of victory. 我们距胜利只有一步之遥。

have/hold (all) the 'aces (also hold all the 'cards)	握有王牌；占绝对优势	常★★★★ □★★★★	The Labour Party candidate holds all the aces — he's local and well liked. 工党候选人占尽优势:他是本地人，而且深受公众喜爱。
an/sb's Achilles' 'heel	致命弱点；阿喀琉斯之踵	常★★★★ □★★★★	Hus pride proved to be his Achilles' heel. 狂妄自大成了他的致命弱点。③
the 'acid 'test (of sth) (also the 'litmus test especially in AmE)	决定性的考验；试金石	常★★★★ □★★★★	They've always been good friends, but the acid test will come when they have to share a flat. 他们一直是好朋友，可是两个人必须合住一套公寓，真正的考验快要到了。⑦
make sb's ac'quaintance *make the ac'quaintance of sb	结识某人；与某人初次相见	常★★★★ □★★★	I am delighted to make your acquaintance, Mrs Baker. 贝克夫人，很高兴认识您。
an acquired 'taste	逐渐培养出来的爱好	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Whisky is an acquired taste. 威士忌酒要喝惯了才会喜欢。
an 'act of 'God (law)	天灾；不可抗力	常★★★★ □★★	The insurance covers Your house against all types of damage, excluding those caused by acts of God. 这份保险单承保房屋可能受到的各种损坏，但不包括自然灾害造成的损害。
a 'balancing/juggling act	搞平衡；两头兼顾	常★★★★ □★★★★	The UN must perform a delicate balancing act between the different sides involved in the conflict. 联合国必须在冲突各方之间寻求微妙的平衡。
be/get in on the 'act (informal)	(在他人成功后) 插一手；参与分羹	常★★★ □★★★★★	Once the café took off, every landlord wanted to get in on the act. 咖啡馆一火，每个房东都想来插一脚。(自拟)
'vanishing act (informal)	(需要时) 消失不见；找不到人	常★★★★ □★★★★★	He pulled his usual vanishing act the moment the bill arrived. 账单一送来，他又照例玩起了人间蒸发。(自拟)
get your 'act together *get sth/it to 'gether (informal) (also get/have your 'shit together, ♦ slang)	振作起来；把事情安排妥当	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	You need to get your act together before the exams start next month. 下个月考试前你得好好振作起来。(自拟)
a hard/tough act to 'follow	难以超越的人(或事)	常★★★★ □★★★★	The last head teacher achieved a lot – she'll be a hard act to follow. 前任校长成就卓著，接替者将难以望其项背。
'action stations (spoken, especially BrE)	(下令准备行动) 各就各位	常★★★ □★★★★★	Action stations, everyone — the inspectors will be here in ten minutes! 各就各位，各位，检查员十分钟后就到！(自拟)
in 'action	在工作；在运转；活动中	常★★★★ □★★★★	John's a great cook – you should see him in action. 约翰的厨艺了不起，你应该看看他做饭的样子。
out of 'action	(因伤病) 不能工作；(因损坏) 失灵	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Jane's broken leg will put her out of action for a while. 简的腿骨折了，她这段时间将不能工作。
a piece/slice of the 'action (informal)	(利益的) 一份；一杯羹	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Foreign firms will all want a piece of the action if the new airport goes ahead. 新机场倘若能开建，外国公司都会想分得一杯羹。
where the 'action is	热闹之处；活动中心	常★★★★ □★★★★★	I'd hate to live out in the country — I like to be where the action is. 我不愿意住在乡下，我喜欢热闹的地方。
ad 'hoc (from Latin)	临时的；特设的；专门的	常★★★★★ □★★	They set up an ad hoc committee to deal with the parking complaints. 他们成立了一个临时委员会处理停车投诉。(自拟)
ad infi'nitum (from Latin)	无休止地；反复不停地	常★★★ □★★	You cannot stay here ad infinitum without paying any rent. 你不能一分钱房租也不付一直住在这里。
ad 'nauseam (from Latin)	(因重复而) 令人厌烦地	常★★★ □★★	The coach discussed our defensive mistakes ad nauseam after the match. 赛后教练把我们的防守失误说得人耳朵起茧。(自拟)
add 'fuel to the 'fire/ 'flames	火上浇油	常★★★★★ □★★★★	She was already furious and his apologies and excuses only added fuel to the flames. 她本来就怒不可遏，他的道歉和解释只能是火上浇油。
'pour oil on troubled 'water(s)	平息争端；调解纠纷	常★★★ □★★	Grandma poured oil on troubled waters by changing the subject quickly. 奶奶赶紧换了话题，把这场争吵平息了下去。(自拟)
add 'insult to 'injury	雪上加霜；伤害之外又加侮辱	常★★★★★ □★★★★	She forgot to send me an invitation to her party and then added insult to injury by asking to borrow my jacket! 她忘了邀请我参加她的聚会，更气人的是，还要向我借夹克衫！
without further/more a'do (old-fashioned)	立即；干脆地；不再耽搁	常★★★ □★	Without further ado, let me introduce tonight's very special guest. 闲话少说，我来介绍今晚这位特别嘉宾。(自拟)
in ad'vance (of sth)	预先；事先	常★★★★★ □★★★★	You have to book the tickets at least two weeks in advance. 票必须至少提前两周订。(自拟)
take ad'vantage of sth/sb	利用某机会；占某人便宜	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We made sure that we took full advantage of the hotel facilities. 我们确保已充分享用了酒店的设施。
to sb's ad'vantage	对某人有利	常★★★★★ □★★★★	The rise in the value of the pound will work to the advantage of those planning a trip abroad this summer. 英镑升值对计划今年夏天出国的人有利。
to (good, better, etc.) ad'vantage	有效地；更出色地	常★★★ □★★	You would be spending your time to better advantage if you did what I suggested. 你要是按我的建议去做，你的时间会得到更有效的利用。
turn sth to your (own) ad'vantage	转害为利；为己所用	常★★★★ □★★	She had three rooms in the house after her children left home, so she decided to turn this to her advantage and rent them out to students. 她的几个孩子长大离家以后，房子里空出来三个房间，所以她打算充分利用，把它们租给学生。
far/farther/further a 'field	在远处；到远方	常★★★ □★★	You can hire a car if you want to explore further afield. 你要是还想游览更远的地方，可以租辆车。
I'm afraid (that)... (spoken)	(礼貌地表歉意) 恐怕；很遗憾	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	I'm afraid I can't come to your party. 很遗憾，我不能参加你们的聚会。

after 'all	毕竟；终究；还是	常★★★★★ □★★★★	I think I will have something to eat after all. 我想我还是吃点东西吧。
a gain and a gain	一再；反复地；屡次	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Tve told him again and again to shut the door but he always leaves it open. 我三番五次告诉他要把门关上，可是他总是不关。
then/there a gain (informal)	另一方面；话说回来	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	lthought he liked me, but then again maybe he didn'. 我觉得他喜欢我，但也许他并不喜欢我。
,act/,be your 'age (informal)	别孩子气；举止要与年龄相称	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	You're behaving like a couple of kids.Act your age! 你俩表现得像小孩一样，要懂事点！
,come of 'age	成年；达到法定年龄；发展成熟	常★★★★★ □★★★★	He will inherit his father's money when he comes of age. 他成年后将会继承父亲的财产。 2 (
,look your 'age	看上去与年龄相称	常★★★★★ □★★★★	I was surprised when I last saw her — she's really starting to look her age now. 最近一次看到她时我很吃惊，她现在真的开始显老了。
,under 'age	未成年；未到法定年龄	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We don't serve alcohol to teenagers who are under age/to under-age teenagers. 我们不卖酒给未成年人。
on 'aggregate (BrE, sport)	按（比赛）总比分	常★★★ □★★	They won 4-2 on aggregare. 他们以 4:2 的总分获胜。
a gree to 'differ	各自保留意见；同意存异	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Our views on this matter are so different that we ll just have to agree to difer. 我们在这一问题上的看法分歧很大，看来大家只能保留各自的意见了。
I ,couldn't agree (with you) 'more	我完全同意	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	I couldn't agree with you more about the need to hire extra staff. 在需要雇用更多员工的问题上，我与你的意见完全一致。
in aid of sb/sth (BrE)	为支援（或帮助）某人（某事）	常★★★★★ □★★★★	The children spent the day collecting money in aid of charity. 孩子们一整天都在为慈善事业募捐。
what's (all) 'this, etc. in aid of? (BrE, spoken)	这究竟是为什 么；这有什么用	常★ □★★★★★	What's all this crying in aid of? 这样号啕大哭到底是怎么了？
take 'aim at sb/sth (AmE)	把矛头指向；集中批评	常★★★★★ □★★★★	The unions are taking aim at the government. 工会组织正把矛头指向政府。
float/walk on 'air (informal)	欢天喜地；喜气洋洋	常★★★ □★★★★★	When I passed my driving test, I was walking on air for days. 通过了驾照考试以后，我飘飘然高兴了好几天。
in the 'air	（想法、气氛等）在流传；即将到来	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Spring is in the air. 春意盎然。
(up) in the 'air	（计划等）悬而未决；未确定	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	Our plans for the decided summer are still very much up in the air. 我们的暑期计划还没确定。
,on/,off the 'air	正在 / 停止播出	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Careful what you say — we're back on the air in ten seconds. 说话注意点，十秒后我们就恢复直播了。（自拟）
airs and 'graces (BrE, disapproving)	摆架子；矫揉造作	常★★★ □★★★★	Her airs and graces didn't impress her fellow students at all. 同学们对她装模作样的表现不以为然。
give yourself/ put on 'airs	摆架子；装腔作势	常★★★ □★★★★	The nice thing about her is that, in spite of being so rich, she doesn't put on any airs. 她的可爱之处在于，尽管很有钱，却并不趾高气扬。
an Aladdin's 'cave	藏有大量珍宝的地方	常★ □★★	He kept for his private pleasure an Aladdin's cave of stolen masterpieces. 他收藏着一屋子偷来的杰作，供自己私下里欣赏。 ③
a live and 'kicking (informal)	健在的；生气勃勃的	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	The old prejudices were still very much alive and kicking. 那些陈旧的偏见依然很盛行。
bring sth a 'live	使生动有趣；使活起来	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Maps and picrures bring the book alive. 地图和图画使这本书趣味盎然。
come a 'live	（话题或活动）活跃起来；变得有趣	常★★★★★ □★★★★	The square comes alive at night when the food stalls open. 夜里小吃摊一开张，广场就热闹起来了。（自拟）
all in 'all	从各方面看；总的来说	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	All in all the conference was a great success, despite the problems at the beginning. 总的说来，这次会议极为成功，尽管一开始有些
all 'round (BrE) (AmE all a 'round)	全面地；在各方面	常★★★★★ □★★★★	It was a better performance all round than the one last season. 比起上赛季，这场表现全面提升。（自拟）
,all 'there (informal)	头脑清醒；思维清晰	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	He behaves very oddly at tumes—I don't think he's quite all there. 他有时候行为很怪异，我想他可能脑子有问题。 1
and all 'that (rubbish, stuff, etc.) (informal)	以及诸如此类的事情	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	He was an intellectual — read Beckett and Barthes and all that. 他算是个知识分子，读的书都是贝克特、巴特之类的。
(not) at 'all	一点儿也不；丝毫不	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	This isn't at all what I expected. 这跟我预想的完全不一样。
be all about sb/sth (informal)	以...为主题（或核心）	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	Thus book ts all about Greece. 这本书讲的全是希腊。 0
be all sb can/could 'do (not) to do sth (informal)	要（不）做某事很难	常★★★ □★★★★★	His face looked so funny that it was all she could do not to laugh. 他的脸看起来那么滑稽，她好不容易才忍住没有笑出来。

(not) be/take all 'day, 'morning, etc. (to do sth)	(不要) 花太长时间做某事	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Don't take all day choosing a shirt; the shop closes at six. 别挑衬衫挑一整天, 店里六点关门。(自拟)
•not have all 'day, etc. (informal)	(催促) 没那么多时间; 快点	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Hurry up and decide — I haven't got all day to stand here. 快点定吧, 我可没工夫在这儿干站着。(自拟)
be all for sth/for doing sth	完全赞成; 坚信应该做某事	常★★★★ □★★★★	I'm all for letting the kids walk to school by themselves. 我完全赞成让孩子们自己走路上学。(自拟)
be all 'go (BrE, informal)	忙个不停; 十分活跃	常★ □★★★★★	It was all go in the office today. 今天办公室里忙得不可开交。
be all 'over sb (informal)	巴结某人; 对某人献殷勤	常★★★★ □★★★★★	He was all over her at the party. 他在聚会上向她大献殷勤。
be all the 'same to sb (also be all 'one to sb old-fashioned)	无所谓; 对某人都一样	常★★★★ □★★★★	Tea or coffee, it's all the same to me this early. 这么早, 茶还是咖啡对我都一样。(自拟)
be all 'that (AmE, informal)	了不起; 很有魅力	常★★ □★★★★★	He thinks he's all that. 他觉得自己很有魅力。
in 'all	一共; 总计	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We've got six litres of milk in all. 我们总共有六升牛奶。
it's/they're 'all 'yours	(移交时说) 全交给你了	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Here are the keys and the paperwork — it's all yours now. 钥匙和文件都在这儿, 现在全归你了。(自拟)
not all that 'good, 'well, etc.	不是特别好; 没那么好	常★★★★ □★★★★	He doesn't sing all that well. 他唱得并不怎么好听。
not as 'bad(ly), 'tall, etc. as all 'that	没有说的那么糟 (或高等)	常★★★★ □★★★★	The exam wasn't as hard as all that; I finished with time to spare. 考试没传的那么难, 我还提前做完了。(自拟)
of 'all the 'cheek, 'nerve, stupid things to 'do, etc.!(informal)	(表恼怒) 竟做出这种事	常★★ □★★★★★	Of all the idiots, leaving his car unlocked in the middle of town! 真是个白痴!把车子放在闹市连锁也不锁!
give sb/get the all-'clear	发出 / 收到警报解除的信号	常★★★★ □★★★★	She got the all-clear from the doctor and was sent home from the hospital. 医生说她已经没有危险, 就让她出院回家了。⑦
a 'blind 'alley	死胡同; 徒劳无功的路子	常★★ □★★★★	That line of research turned out to be a blind alley after two years. 两年下来, 那条研究路线证明是条死胡同。(自拟)
allow 'me (spoken)	(礼貌地提出帮忙) 我来吧	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Allow me, that suitcase looks far too heavy for one person. 我来吧, 那箱子一个人拎太沉了。(自拟)
give/allow sb/sth free/full 'rein	放手让...自由发挥	常★★★★ □★★	The editor gave the young writer free rein with the travel column. 编辑放手让这位年轻作者自由写旅行专栏。(自拟)
make al'lowances for sb	体谅某人; 考虑到某人的难处	常★★★★ □★★★★	The court was asked to make allowances for the age of the accused. 请求法庭考虑被告的年龄。
go it a' lone (informal)	单干; 独立去做	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Andrew decided to go it alone and start his own business. 安德鲁决定独立创办自己的公司。
leave/let sb a' lone •leave/let sb 'be	别打扰某人; 别干预	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	Just leave him alone for an hour; he'll calm down on his own. 让他一个人待一小时, 他自己会平静下来。(自拟)
leave/let sth a' lone •leave/let sth 'be	别碰; 别乱动	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	I've told you before — leave my things alone! 我跟你说过, 不要碰我的东西!
let a' lone	更不用说; 遑论	常★★★★★ □★★★★	He can't boil an egg, let alone cook dinner for eight people. 他连鸡蛋都煮不好, 更别提给八个人做饭了。(自拟)
along with sth	连同; 除...之外还有	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Tobacco is taxed in most countries, along with alcohol. 跟酒一样, 烟草在大多数国家也要征税。
as 'always	一如既往; 像平常一样	常★★★★★ □★★★★	As always, Polly was late for school. 波莉同往常一样, 上学又迟到了。
make a'mends (to sb) (for sth/for doing sth)	赔罪; 补偿; 将功补过	常★★★★ □★★★★	He cooked dinner to make amends for forgetting their anniversary. 他做了顿晚饭, 弥补自己忘了纪念日的过失。(自拟)
as A'merican as 'apple 'pie	地道美国式的	常★★ □★★★★	For me, baseball is as American as apple pie. 对我来说, 棒球同苹果派一样是地道的美国玩意儿。
not come/go a'miss (BrE)	倒也不错; 正合时宜; 有用	常★★ □★★★★	A little luck wouldn't go amiss right now! 现在要是交点好运倒也不错!
take sth a'miss (BrE)	(因误会) 对...生气; 见怪	常★★ □★★★★	Would she take it amiss if I offered to help? 要是我提出帮忙, 她会见怪吗?
opp take sth in good 'part	不见怪地接受; 一笑置之	常★★ □★★★★	He took the teasing about his haircut in good part. 大家拿他的发型开玩笑, 他一笑置之。(自拟)
run a'mok	失去控制; 发狂; 肆虐	常★★ □★★★★	The crowd through the city streets when they heard their leaders had been killed. 得知他们的头目被杀, 这人群开始在城里大街上到处疯狂地胡作非为。③
any a'mount/number of sth	大量的; 许多的	常★★★★ □★★★★	There was any amount of food and drink at the party. 聚会上有的是吃的喝的。

no a'mount of sth	再多...也没用	常★★★★ □★★★★	No amount of encouragement would make him jump into the pool. 再怎么鼓励他也不肯跳入游泳池中。
keep sb a'mused	让某人开心; 给某人解闷	常★★★★ □★★★★	Playing with water can keep children amused for hours. 孩子们玩起水来, 能兴致勃勃一直玩上好几个小时。
in the ,last/ ,final a 'nalysis	归根结底; 总之	常★★★★ □★★	In the final analysis, humour is a matter of individual interpretation. 总之, 幽默全凭个人的诠释。
the ,answer to sb's 'prayers	求之不得的人 (或事物)	常★★★★ □★★★★	If you've been looking for a good quality fleece at a reasonable price, this one could be the answer to your prayers. 如果你想买一件价格合理、质量上乘的抓绒衣, 这一件可能会合你的心意。
not take ,no for an 'answer	非让人答应不可; 不容拒绝	常★★★★ □★★★★	You're coming and I won't take no for an answer! 你一定要来, 不来我可不同意!
have/know all the 'answers	自以为无所不知; 万事通	常★★★★ □★★★★	He's an economist who thinks he knows all the answers. 他是个自以为什么都懂的经济学家。
raise/up the ,ante	加大筹码; 提高要价	常★★★ □★★★★	His ex-wife has upped the ante in her alimony suit against him. 他的前妻在赡养费诉讼中提高了要求。
have ,ants in your pants (informal)	坐立不安; 焦躁不安	常★★★ □★★★★★	Relax and enjoy yourself — you've really got ants in your pants about something tonight! 放松点儿, 好好玩吧。今晚你好像有什么事, 坐立不安的!
anything ,but	绝对不; 恰恰相反	常★★★★★ □★★★★	Ecologists are anything but optimistic about a change in the Government's attitude towards green issues. 对于政府是否会转变对环保的态度, 生态保护论者一点儿都不乐观。
anything ,goes	怎么都行; 没有任何规矩	常★★★★ □★★★★	John always has to wear a suit and tie to the office, but where I work anything goes. 约翰上班必须穿西装打领带, 而我上
anything ,like	(用于否定或疑问) 差不多; 有点像	常★★★★★ □★★★★	If the meal's anything like the one we had there, you'll really enjoy it. 如果这顿饭同我们在那儿吃过的差不多, 你一定会喜欢的。
(as) easy, clear, quick, etc. as ,anything	极其容易 (或清楚、迅速等)	常★★★ □★★★★	It was only a small gift but Phil was as pleased as anything with it. 只是一件小礼物, 可是菲尔高兴得跟什么似的。
like ,anything (BrE, informal)	非常; 拼命地	常★★★ □★★★★★	My head hurt like anything. 我的头疼死了。
not for ,anything (informal)	决不; 无论如何也不	常★★★★ □★★★★	I wouldn't give it up for anything. 我决不放弃。
or ,anything (spoken)	或类似的什么	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	If you want to call a meeting or anything, just let me know. 如果你想召集个会议什么的, 就请告诉我。
be ,poles/ ,worlds apart	天差地别; 大相径庭	常★★★★ □★★★★	Politically, the two leaders are poles apart. 两位领导人的政治观点截然不同。
come/fall apart at the 'seams (informal)	土崩瓦解; 开始崩溃	常★★★ □★★★★	The Government's economic policy is falling apart at the seams. 政府的经济政策开始失效了。
an a'pology for sth	勉强凑合的替代品	常★ □★★	They served us a sad apology for a breakfast at that hotel. 那家旅馆给我们端上的所谓早餐真够寒碜的。(自拟)
make no a'pology/a 'pologies for sth	不为某事道歉; 问心无愧	常★★★★ □★★	Having grown up in the north of the country, I make no apologies for saying that people there are more friendly than people in the south. 我在北方长大, 我打心底里觉得北方人比南方人友好。
keep up ap'pearances	装门面; 维持体面	常★★★★ □★★★★	They kept up appearances long after the money had run out. 钱早就花光了, 他们还硬撑着面子。(自拟)
the apple doesn't fall/never falls far from the ,tree (saying, especially AmE)	有其父必有其子	常★★★★ □★★★★	She paints just like her mother; the apple never falls far from the tree. 她画画跟她妈一模一样, 真是一脉相承。(自拟)
the ,apple of sb's ,eye	掌上明珠; 心肝宝贝	常★★★★ □★★★★	The second child, John, was the apple of his mother's eye. 老二约翰是他妈妈的心肝宝贝。⑦
a bad/rotten ,apple	害群之马	常★★★★ □★★★★	One rotten apple in the team can ruin the mood for everyone. 队里一个害群之马能坏了所有人的心情。(自拟)
in apple-pie ,order	井井有条; 整整齐齐	常★★★ □★★★★	She keeps the accounts in apple-pie order. 她
,apples and ,oranges (AmE)	截然不同的事物; 不可比	常★★★★★ □★★★★	He was no competition for me: it was like apples and oranges. 他
how do you like ,them apples? •how	(得意地) 怎么样, 服不服	常★★★ □★★★★★	I finished the whole race without walking — how do you like them apples? 全程跑下来没走一步, 怎么样, 服不服? (自拟)
about ,them apples? (AmE, informal, usually spoken)	(得意或挑衅) 你觉得如何	常★★★ □★★★★★	We beat the champions on their own field — how about them apples? 我们在冠军队主场赢了他们, 你说厉害不厉害? (自拟)
she's ,apples (AustralE, New Zealand, informal)	没问题; 一切都好	常★ □★★★★★	Fix the tyre and she's apples, mate, we'll be on the road again. 轮胎补好就没问题了, 哥们儿, 咱们又能上路了。(自拟)
a/the ,softly- ,softly approach	温和谨慎的做法	常★★★ □★★★★	With teenagers, a softly-softly approach usually works better. 对青春期的孩子, 温和一点的办法通常更管用。(自拟)
on ap'proval	(商品) 供试用的; 可退还的	常★★★ □★★	The bookshop sent me the atlas on approval for ten days. 书店把那本地图册寄给我试看十天。(自拟)

(tied to) your mother's, wife's, etc. 'apron strings	受母亲（或妻子等）控制	常★★ □★★★★	At thirty he's still tied to his mother's apron strings. 三十岁了，他还事事听母亲的。（自拟）
be out of the 'ark •went out with the 'ark	（物品或习俗）极为老旧过时	常★ □★★★★	That printer is out of the ark; it still uses floppy disks. 那台打印机老掉牙了，还在用软盘。（自拟）
cost/pay an 'arm and a 'leg (informal)	花一大笔钱；价格昂贵	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Getting the roof fixed cost us an arm and a leg last winter. 去年冬天修屋顶花了我们一大笔钱。（自拟）
keep sb at arm's 'length	与某人保持距离；不与之亲近	常★★★★ □★★★★	She keeps her colleagues at arm's length outside working hours. 下班后她跟同事保持距离。（自拟）
put the 'arm/'bite on sb (AmE, informal)	向某人讨要（尤指钱）	常★ □★★★★	To pay for the tax reductions, the government will put the bite on smokers and motorists. 为了弥补减税造成的损失，政府会将这笔账加到吸烟者和开车族身上。
armed to the 'teeth (with sth) (informal)	全副武装；武装到牙齿	常★★★★ □★★★★	The tourists got out of the coach, armed to the teeth with cameras, binoculars, and guidebooks. 游客下了大客车，一个个全副武装，带着相机、双筒望远镜和旅游指南。
up in 'arms (about/over sth) (informal)	强烈抗议；极力反对	常★★★★ □★★★★	Local residents are up in arms over plans to build a new motorway. 当地居民极力反对新建一条高速公路的计划。
My 'arse! (BrE, ◆ slang)	胡说；我才不信	常★ □★★★★★	An appointment at the dentist my arse! She's shopping! 约好看牙医？我才不信这屁
work your 'arse off (BrE) (AmE work your 'ass off) (◆ slang)	拼命干活	常★★★★ □★★★★★	I worked my arse off all summer to pay for that guitar. 整个夏天我拼命打工，就为买那把吉他。（自拟）
can't be 'arsed (to do sth) (BrE, ◆ slang)	懒得做某事	常★★ □★★★★★	I was supposed to do some work this weekend but I couldn't be arsed. 这个周末我本来应该干点活，可是我懒得去做。
as a'gainst sth	与...相比；与...相对照	常★★ □★★	They got 27% of the vote as against 32% at the last election. 这次选举他们的得票率为 27%，而上次是32%。
,as and 'when	在...的时候；一旦	常★★ □★★★★	I'll deal with those emails as and when I get a free hour. 等哪会儿有空我再处理那些邮件。（自拟）
as for sb/sth	至于某人（某事）；关于	常★★★★★ □★★★★	I like Sue very much, but as for her boyfriend — I wouldn't care if I never saw him again! 我很喜欢苏，至于她的男朋友，我巴不得再也见不到他！
'as from (also 'as of especially AmE)	自...起	常★★★★ □★★	As from Monday, the office will open half an hour earlier. 从周一一起，办公室提前半小时开门。（自拟）
as 'if (spoken)	（表不信或否认）才怪；好像似的	常★★★★ □★★★★★	As if I really cared! 好像谁稀罕似的！O
as 'if/as 'though	好像；仿佛	常★★★★★ □★★★★	He talks about the war as though he had actually been there. 他谈起那场战争，好像自己真去过一样。（自拟）
,as it 'is	照现状看；实际上	常★★★★ □★★★★	I wanted to have this report ready by tomorrow but as it is, it may not be done until Thursday. 我本想明天前就把这份报告弄好，看样子可能得等到星期四了。
as to sth	至于某事；关于某事	常★★★★ □★★	As to tax, that will be deducted from your salary. 至于税款，将从你的薪水里扣除。
as you 'do (BrE)	（调侃）人之常情嘛；就这样呗	常★★ □★★★★★	He smiled and I smiled back, as you do. 他微微一笑，我也报以微笑，就这样而已。• (
'ask for trouble/it (informal)	自找麻烦；自讨苦吃	常★★★★ □★★★★	They're asking for trouble, leaving young children alone in the house like that. 他们就那样把年幼的孩子独自留在家里，这会惹祸的。
don't 'ask (spoken, informal)	别问了；不问为好	常★★★★ □★★★★★	How was the interview? Oh, don't ask, it was a disaster. 面试怎么样？唉，别问了，一塌糊涂。（自拟）
,don't ask 'me (spoken, informal)	别问我；我怎么知道	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Don't ask me — nobody tells me anything around here. 别问我，谁也没告诉我这儿的任何情况。
I 'ask you! (spoken, informal)	（表震惊）真是的；你说气不气人	常★★ □★★★★★	So they just arrived without telling you they were coming? Well, I ask you! 这么说他们没跟你说一声就来了？哦，好家伙！
if you ask 'me (spoken, informal)	依我看；我认为	常★★★★ □★★★★★	If you ask me, Mark shouldn't have bought that car — it just wasn't worth the money. 依我看，马克不应该买那辆车，它根本就不值那个价。
be sb's for the 'asking	只要开口就能得到	常★★ □★★★★	If you want any of the furniture, it's yours for the asking. 这些家具你想要哪件，只管开口就行。
asleep at the 'wheel (especially BrE) (AmE)	玩忽职守；没留意潜在问题	常★★★★ □★★★★	The regulators were asleep at the wheel while the bank collapsed. 银行垮台时，监管机构完全在打瞌睡。（自拟）
get your 'ass over/in 'here, etc. (◆ slang, especially AmE)	（粗俗）快滚过来；到这边来	常★★ □★★★★★	Get your ass over here and help me move this couch! 快给我滚过来帮忙抬沙发！（自拟）
go a'stray	丢失；误入歧途	常★★★★ □★★★★	Several letters went astray or were not delivered. 有几封信丢失了，要么是未送达。
you could 'cut the atmosphere with a 'knife (informal)	气氛紧张；剑拔弩张	常★★ □★★★★	When John came in with his new girlfriend, you could have cut the atmosphere with a knife. 约翰带着新女友进来时，气氛极其紧张。
be in at'tendance (formal)	出席；到场	常★★★★ □★★	Several heads of state were in attendance at the funeral. 好几位国家元首出席了葬礼。

take at'tendance (AmE)	点名；查考勤	常★★★★ □★★★★	The teacher took attendance at the beginning of every class. 每次一上课老师都要点名。
get/have sb's un ,divided at'tention	得到某人的全神贯注	常★★★★ □★★★★	Put your phone down — I want your undivided attention for five minutes. 把手机放下，我要你专心听我说五分钟。(自拟)
have sth on good au 'thority	有可靠根据；消息来源可靠	常★★★ □★★	I have it on good authorty that the Chairman is going to resign. 董事长要辞职了，我这个消息是有根有据的。
be on ,automatic 'pilot	不假思索地做；机械地做	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Igot up and dressed on automatic pilot. 我机械地起了床，穿上衣服。
of little/no a'vail (formal)	没有多大用处；无济于事	常★★★ □★	His long letters of complaint were of no avail whatsoever. 他那些长篇投诉信一点用都没有。(自拟)
to little/no a'vail (formal)	徒劳无功；没有成效	常★★★ □★	The doctors tried everything to keep him alive but to no avail. 医生们竭尽全力抢救他的生命，但却徒劳无功。
avoid sb/sth like the 'plague (informal)	极力躲避；避之唯恐不及	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	It was the sort of restaurant that I would normally have avoided like the plague. 这样的餐馆我通常都是避之唯恐不及。
be/stand in 'awe of sb/sth	敬畏；对...肃然起敬	常★★★★ □★★★★	As a student I stood in awe of that quiet old professor. 当学生时，我对那位安静的老教授敬畏有加。(自拟)
the 'awkward age	尴尬年龄（青春期初）	常★ □★★★★	He's at the awkward age when nothing his parents say is right. 他正处在那个别扭的年纪，爸妈说什么都不对。(自拟)
have an 'axe to grind	别有用心；另有企图	常★★★★ □★★★★	Having no particular political axe to grind, he stood for election as an independent candidate. 他作为独立候选人参加竞选，没有特别的政治企图。
a ,babe in 'arms (old-fashioned)	襁褓中的婴儿；不谙世事的人	常★ □★★	When it comes to contracts, he's still a babe in arms. 一说到合同，他还完全是个新手。(自拟)
a ,babe in the 'woods (AmE)	毫无经验的人；易受骗的人	常★★★ □★★★★	On his first day trading he was a babe in the woods. 他做交易的头一天完全是只小白兔。(自拟)
be sb's 'baby (informal)	是某人的心血；归某人负责	常★★★★ □★★★★★	Mary's the lawyer, so the legal problem's her baby. 玛丽是律师，法律问题归她管。
throw the ,baby out with the 'bathwater	把精华与糟粕一起丢掉	常★★★★ □★★★★	It's stupid to say that the old system of management was all bad; there were some good things about it. The baby was thrown out with the bathwater. 说旧的管理体制一无是处是愚蠢的，它也有好的地方。
on the back 'burner	暂缓处理；搁置一边	常★★★★★ □★★★★★	We've put the kitchen renovation on the back burner until spring. 厨房翻新的事我们先搁到春天再说。(自拟)
(in) back of sth (AmE, informal)	在...后面；在...背后	常★★★★ □★★★★★	The kids' bikes are in back of the garage, behind the old fridge. 孩子们的自行车在车库后面，旧冰箱那边。(自拟)
the ,back of be'yond (informal)	偏远之地；穷乡僻壤	常★★★ □★★★★★	Her cottage is out in the back of beyond, an hour from the nearest shop. 她的小屋在鸟不拉屎的地方，离最近的商店一小时。(自拟)
,back to 'back	背靠背；接连地	常★★★★★ □★★★★	We watched two films back to back and forgot to have dinner. 我们连着看了两部电影，忘了吃晚饭。(自拟)
get/put sb's 'back up	惹恼某人；使某人生气	常★★★ □★★★★★	His silly remarks always get her back up. 他的蠢话总惹得她很恼火。
get off sb's 'back •get sb off your 'back	不再纠缠某人；摆脱某人的烦扰	常★★★★ □★★★★★	I've done all that already, sowhy don't you just get off my back? 我已经把那些都干了，你能
never/not look 'back (informal)	从此一帆风顺；蒸蒸日上	常★★★★ □★★★★★	She hasn't looked back since she started her own business five years qq0. 她五年前开始创业，之后事业一直蒸蒸日上。
put your 'back into sth	全力以赴做某事；卖力干	常★★★ □★★★★★	We'll get the job finished today if we put our backs into it. 要是我们全力以赴，今天就能把这活儿干完。